

ISSUE

No

XIII

TODAY'S EDITORIALS

"IF YOU DON'T LIKE TO READ,
YOU HAVEN'T FOUND THE RIGHT EDITORIALS."



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Latest Editorials



The Hindu,
The Indian Express etc.



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AHEAD
EVERY DAY



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Handpicked Daily



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LIST
Multiple Synonyms,
Tone & Part of
Speech



SMARTER
PREPARATION
Better
Understanding



STRONGER
RESULTS
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ISSUE

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“

No. I can survive well enough on my own—if given the proper reading material.

-SARAH J. MAAS



STAY INFORMED.
STAT AHEAD.
SUCCEED.

17 SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

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Orthodoxy redux: On Keralam, religion and Muslim women's rights

"Kerala's progressive ethos must firmly resist religious dictates curbing Muslim women's public participation."

17 September 3, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Veteran Islamic cleric Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar's directive to restrict Muslim women's participation in public celebrations has **unsettled**² Keralam because it **strikes at**³ a fundamental question: women's right to participate in public life. This is not merely a quarrel over how Muslims should mark Prophet Muhammad's 1,501st birth anniversary. It is a test of how far religious authority can **intrude into**⁴ the lives of women in a State that takes pride in its progressive social history. Kanthapuram says he is merely reminding followers of established religious norms. His supporters argue Milad celebrations have moved beyond mosques and madrasas into large public events, and that scholars have a duty to caution against such **departures**⁵. That argument **holds no weight**⁶. Communities have the right to preserve traditions and regulate religious practices, but they have to **conform to**⁷ the values **enshrined in**⁸ the Constitution. When women are told to remain at home because their presence could cause "chaos", the issue is no longer about religious observance; it is **at variance with**⁹ constitutional equality and Keralam's long struggle to expand the space in public life for women **disadvantaged**¹⁰ by social customs and religious traditions.

The Muslim community is not a **monolith**¹¹. It contains both orthodox and progressive currents. More Muslim women are breaking barriers in education, employment, politics and public life, but that progress is encountering a **counter-current**¹² of renewed orthodoxy and social control. The CPI(M), Keralam's main Opposition party and a decades-old ally of the Kanthapuram-led faction of Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama, a body of Sunni scholars, has responded sharply. The Congress, which leads the ruling coalition, was largely **guarded**¹³ until Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan **rubbished**¹⁴ the **decree**¹⁵ as **antediluvian**¹⁶. The Indian Union Muslim League's silence is harder to defend. A party with an active women's forum and a woman legislator for the first time in the State Assembly cannot **equivocate**¹⁷ when women's right to public participation is **open to challenge**¹⁸. Its caution may reflect political pressure over Waqf, Vande Mataram and PM-SHRI, or an attempt to improve ties with the Kanthapuram faction amid strained relations with the rival Samastha faction. Whatever the political calculation, silence carries a cost. Religious freedom does not **confer on**¹⁹ religious authorities the right to regulate women's freedom of movement, association and degree of participation in society. During Onam, social media were **awash with**²⁰ videos of young Muslim girls celebrating the harvest festival. Kanthapuram's remarks drew criticism from a section of Muslim women on social media. Keralam cannot claim to be progressive while **making exceptions for**²¹ orthodoxy.

★ VOCABULARY 101

- 1 **Redux** (Adjective)
revived • पुनरुत्थान या वापसी
- 2 **Unsettled** (Verb)
disturbed • अशांत कर दिया
- 3 **Strikes at** (Verb)
attacks • पर गहरा प्रहार करना
- 4 **Intrude into** (Verb)
interfere in • अनाधिकार हस्तक्षेप करना
- 5 **Departures** (Noun)
deviations • परंपरा या नियम से भटकाव
- 6 **Holds no weight** (Phrase)
lacks validity • तर्कहीन या महत्वहीन होना
- 7 **Conform to** (Verb)
follow • के अनुसार होना या पालन करना
- 8 **Enshrined in** (Verb)
protected in • पवित्र रूप से स्थापित या संरक्षित
- 9 **At variance with** (Phrase)
in conflict with • के विपरीत या असंगत
- 10 **Disadvantaged** (Adjective)
underprivileged • वंचित या पिछड़ा हुआ
- 11 **Monolith** (Noun)
single entity • एकसमान या अविभाज्य समूह
- 12 **Counter-current** (Noun)
opposing trend • विपरीत धारा
- 13 **Guarded** (Adjective)
cautious • सतर्क या संकोची
- 14 **Rubbished** (Verb)
rejected strongly • पूरी तरह खारिज करना या बकवास बताना
- 15 **Decree** (Noun)
official order • आधिकारिक या धार्मिक फरमान
- 16 **Antediluvian** (Adjective)
primitive • अति प्राचीन या अत्यंत दकियानूसी
- 17 **Equivocate** (Verb)
dodge the truth • गोलमोल बात करना या टालमटोल करना
- 18 **Open to challenge** (Phrase)
vulnerable to dispute • विवाद या चुनौती के लिए खुला होना
- 19 **Confer on** (Verb)
grant to • प्रदान करना या सौंपना
- 20 **Awash with** (Adjective)
full of • से सरबोर या भरा हुआ
- 21 **Making exceptions for** (Phrase)
exempting • के लिए विशेष छूट देना



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EDITORIAL STANCE

DISAPPROVING

"strongly objecting to orthodoxy"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author takes a firm stance against regressive clerical directives aimed at curtailing Muslim women's presence in public spaces. By invoking constitutional principles and Kerala's reformist heritage, the editorial condemns political equivocation and asserts that religious autonomy cannot override fundamental gender equality.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

8 WORDS

01	Unsettled VERB NEGATIVE	अशांत कर दिया Caused someone or a society to feel anxious, disturbed, or unstable.	MEMORY HOOK Un + settled: losing one's settled peace of mind or calm stability.	SYNONYMS • disconcerted • perturbed • agitated	ANTONYMS • composed • reassured • pacified
02	Departures NOUN NEUTRAL	परंपरा या नियम से भटकाव Divergences or variations from established rules, customs, or accepted norms.	MEMORY HOOK When a train departs, it leaves the platform; when an action is a departure, it leaves standard custom.	SYNONYMS • deviations • divergences • aberrations	ANTONYMS • conformities • adherences • continuations
03	Disadvantaged ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	वंचित या पिछड़ा हुआ Placed in an unfavourable or deprived position regarding social rights and opportunities.	MEMORY HOOK Dis (not) + advantaged: denied the basic opportunities and benefits enjoyed by others.	SYNONYMS • marginalised • deprived • underprivileged	ANTONYMS • privileged • advantaged • empowered
04	Counter-current NOUN NEGATIVE	विपरीत धारा A trend or tendency running contrary to the predominant movement or prevailing progress.	MEMORY HOOK A current flowing in the counter (opposite) direction against the main tide.	SYNONYMS • backlash • counteraction • reversal	ANTONYMS • mainstream • momentum • concurrence
05	Guarded ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	सतर्क या संकोची Careful, restrained, and unwilling to reveal true opinions or commit firmly.	MEMORY HOOK Keeping your guard up so you don't reveal too much or make commitments.	SYNONYMS • circumspect • non-committal • reticent	ANTONYMS • forthright • candid • unreserved
06	Rubbished VERB NEGATIVE	पूरी तरह खारिज करना या बकवास बताना Criticised, ridiculed, or rejected an idea as completely absurd or worthless.	MEMORY HOOK Treating someone's idea like 'rubbish' (trash) by throwing it out with contempt.	SYNONYMS • dismissed • derided • repudiated	ANTONYMS • endorsed • lauded • validated
07	Decree NOUN NEUTRAL	आधिकारिक या धार्मिक फरमान An authoritative order, dictate, or edict having the binding force of law or religious mandate.	MEMORY HOOK Decree rhymes with 'agree'; a command that everyone is ordered to agree with.	SYNONYMS • edict • dictate • pronouncement	ANTONYMS • recommendation • suggestion • petition
08	Equivocate VERB NEGATIVE	गोलमोल बात करना या टालमटोल करना To use ambiguous language to conceal the truth or avoid committing oneself to a clear position.	MEMORY HOOK Equi (equal) + vocal (voice): speaking with two equal voices to confuse the listener.	SYNONYMS • prevaricate • temporise • vacillate	ANTONYMS • clarify • speak frankly • declare openly

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

2 TERMS

01	Monolith NOUN NEUTRAL	एकसमान या अविभाज्य समूह A large, uniform, and indivisible organisation or community that lacks internal diversity.	MEMORY HOOK Mono (single) + lith (stone): a single giant stone, metaphorically meaning a uniform, indivisible body.	SYNONYMS • uniform whole • homogeneous mass • indivisible entity	ANTONYMS • heterogeneous group • plurality • mosaic
02	Antediluvian ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अति प्राचीन या अत्यंत दकियानूसी Extremely old-fashioned, archaic, or ridiculously out of date.	MEMORY HOOK Ante (before) + deluge (the biblical flood): so extremely old that it belongs before Noah's flood.	SYNONYMS • archaic • outmoded • antiquated	ANTONYMS • modern • progressive • contemporary

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

5 TERMS

01	Intrude into VERB NEGATIVE	अनाधिकार हस्तक्षेप करना To enter or force oneself into a private sphere where one is not welcomed or entitled to be.	MEMORY HOOK Intruders enter private spaces without permission; hence 'intrude into' means encroaching unlawfully.	SYNONYMS • encroach on • trespass upon • infringe upon	ANTONYMS • withdraw from • disregard • leave alone
02	Conform to VERB NEUTRAL	के अनुसार होना या पालन करना To comply with rules, standards, laws, or accepted customs.	MEMORY HOOK Conform = comply with the form/standard set by rules.	SYNONYMS • adhere to • abide by • align with	ANTONYMS • deviate from • violate • flout
03	Enshrined in VERB POSITIVE	पवित्र रूप से स्थापित या संरक्षित Preserved, protected, and expressed formally as a cherished right or principle.	MEMORY HOOK Placing something in a 'shrine' preserves it with utmost reverence and permanence.	SYNONYMS • embodied in • entrenched in • safeguarded in	ANTONYMS • excised from • erased from • omitted from
04	Confer on VERB NEUTRAL	प्रदान करना या सौंपना To grant or bestow a title, right, privilege, or power upon someone.	MEMORY HOOK Confer is to offer a right or title upon someone with authority.	SYNONYMS • bestow upon • accord to • grant to	ANTONYMS • divest of • withhold from • strip from
05	Awash with ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	से सराबोर या भरा हुआ Containing large numbers or quantities of something; completely inundated or flooded.	MEMORY HOOK Awash implies being submerged under high waves of water or content.	SYNONYMS • inundated with • replete with • overflowing with	ANTONYMS • devoid of • deficient in • lacking in

PHRASAL VERBS

1 TERMS

01	Strikes at VERB NEGATIVE	पर गहरा प्रहार करना Directly threatens, challenges, or affects the essential foundation of something.	MEMORY HOOK When you strike at the core, you hit the most essential foundation directly.	SYNONYMS • undermines • assails • threatens	ANTONYMS • fortifies • upholds • sustains
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IDIOMS & PHRASES

4 TERMS

01	Holds no weight PHRASE NEGATIVE	तर्कहीन या महत्वहीन होना Lacks convincing force, credibility, or logical significance.	MEMORY HOOK An argument with zero weight will simply blow away because it has no substance.	SYNONYMS • carries no conviction • lacks merit • falls flat	ANTONYMS • holds water • carries weight • remains valid
02	At variance with PHRASE NEGATIVE	के विपरीत या असंगत In direct contradiction, disagreement, or conflict with something else.	MEMORY HOOK Variance means variation or dispute; if you are 'at variance', you vary completely from the norm.	SYNONYMS • incompatible with • contrary to • inconsistent with	ANTONYMS • in harmony with • consistent with • in accord with
03	Open to challenge PHRASE NEGATIVE	विवाद या चुनौती के लिए खुला होना Vulnerable to questioning, opposition, or legal and social contestation.	MEMORY HOOK If a gate is left 'open', anyone can step up and challenge whatever is inside.	SYNONYMS • disputable • contestable • vulnerable	ANTONYMS • indisputable • unassailable • incontestable
04	Making exceptions for PHRASE NEGATIVE	के लिए विशेष छूट देना Allowing a particular person, group, or ideology to be exempt from general rules or progressive standards.	MEMORY HOOK Carving out an 'exception' lets someone bypass the standard rule that applies to all.	SYNONYMS • granting exemptions to • tolerating • indulging	ANTONYMS • applying universally to • enforcing strictly against • disallowing

FOREIGN WORDS

1 TERMS

01	Redux ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	पुनरुत्थान या वापसी Brought back, revived, or restored, especially an idea or condition from the past.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 're-do'; think of something brought back or repeated again.	SYNONYMS • resurgent • revisited • returned	ANTONYMS • extinct • vanished • obsolete
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Many layers: On onion produce, issues

“Reactive market interventions fail to resolve structural flaws in India's agricultural supply chain.”

September 3, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

Since the 1960s, India has developed a **balancing-act**¹ habit: between keeping food prices affordably low for consumers and assuring farmers of **remunerative**² prices, with the state's interventions focused on managing this **volatility**³ in the short term. This is also why the government banned onion exports from December 2023 to May 2024, then imposed a \$550/tonne minimum export price and a 40% export duty, reduced the duty to 20% in September 2024, and finally abolished it in April 2025. But **erratic**⁴ weather together with the lack of long-term relief has **rendered**⁵ the act increasingly awkward. From farmers' point of view, the government often changes its mind after they have made important production-related decisions based on the expected price. On the other hand, during the **bounteous**⁶ rabi harvest, onion farmers in Maharashtra, the country's principal supplier, had argued that the Centre's **procurement**⁷ price of ₹12.35/kg would not cover the costs of cultivation. The Centre **subsequently**⁸ raised the price to up to ₹26.45/kg, but many farmers — including some who had had to sell at ₹1/kg earlier because of low quality and lack of storage, among other factors — were unable to capture the higher value, exposing the limits of intervening after prices have already collapsed and not reaching all farmers or grades of produce.

While the government has **alluded to**⁹ some price **manipulation**¹⁰, the **dominant**¹¹ issue remains that it keeps reacting instead of taking **proactive**¹² measures, including improving storage options, maintaining a less **erratic**⁴ trade policy, moving stock more efficiently between regions, and protecting farmers against price shocks. The abnormal rainfall at the time of harvest and a 5%-7% drop in the kharif crop in Maharashtra, together with the well-known challenges associated with storing onions and maintaining large **buffers**¹³, are simply among the pressures that **highlighted**¹⁴ the flaw this year. Further, Tamil Nadu's targeted subsidy, to buy 1,000 tonnes of onions to distribute 1 kg per ration card at ₹35, will impose pressures on the Centre to maintain a steady supply. The move is **commendably**¹⁵ designed to discourage **hoarding**¹⁶ while allowing private retail prices to **cool down**¹⁷. However, the State must also **guard against**¹⁸ the **pitfalls**¹⁹ of distributing onions through a dry-grain PDS network — its economic case could collapse if post-harvest losses, to which onion is more susceptible than, say, wheat or rice, exceed 10%-15% — and if the need arises to **persist with**²¹ the subsidy. Finally, if other States also adopt similar measures, the Central buffer could be quickly **exhausted**²², more so given this year's high storage losses of around 30%.

★ VOCABULARY 101

- 1 **balancing-act** (Noun)
compromise • संतुलन बनाए रखने का प्रयास
- 2 **remunerative** (Adjective)
profitable • लाभकारी / फलप्रद
- 3 **volatility** (Noun)
instability • अस्थिरता
- 4 **erratic** (Adjective)
unpredictable • अनियमित / डाँवाडोल
- 5 **rendered** (Verb)
made • बना दिया / कर दिया
- 6 **bounteous** (Adjective)
abundant • प्रचुर / भरपूर
- 7 **procurement** (Noun)
purchasing • खरीद / अधिप्राप्ति
- 8 **subsequently** (Adverb)
afterwards • बाद में / तत्पश्चात्
- 9 **alluded to** (Verb)
hinted at • का संकेत देना
- 10 **manipulation** (Noun)
rigging • हेरफेर / जोड़-तोड़
- 11 **dominant** (Adjective)
primary • प्रमुख / मुख्य
- 12 **proactive** (Adjective)
forward-thinking • सक्रिय / अग्रसक्रिय
- 13 **buffers** (Noun)
reserves • सुरक्षित भंडार / बफर स्टॉक
- 14 **highlighted** (Verb)
emphasised • उजागर किया / प्रमुखता दी
- 15 **commendably** (Adverb)
praiseworthy • सराहनीय रूप से
- 16 **hoarding** (Noun)
stockpiling • जमाखोरी
- 17 **cool down** (Verb)
moderate • शांत या स्थिर होना
- 18 **guard against** (Verb)
prevent • से बचाव करना / सावधानी बरतना
- 19 **pitfalls** (Noun)
hazards • छिपे हुए खतरे / कमियाँ
- 20 **susceptible to** (Adjective)
vulnerable to • के प्रति संवेदनशील / अतिसंवेदनशील
- 21 **persist with** (Verb)
continue • जारी रखना / लगे रहना
- 22 **exhausted** (Verb)
depleted • समाप्त / खत्म हो जाना

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EDITORIAL STANCE

CRITICAL

“fault-finding and analytical”

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author evaluates India's agricultural trade interventions, arguing that knee-jerk policy shifts fail both farmers and consumers. By highlighting erratic export duties, inadequate storage infrastructure, and recurring price shocks, the text underscores the limits of reactive governance. The author advocates for proactive, structural reforms over temporary subsidies to achieve long-term market stability.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

14 WORDS

01	remunerative ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	लाभकारी / फलप्रद Earning or paying a substantial amount of profit or financial reward.	MEMORY HOOK Sound like 're-money-rative' — getting good money/profit in return for work.	SYNONYMS • lucrative • profitable • gainful	ANTONYMS • unremunerative • unprofitable • loss-making
02	volatility NOUN NEGATIVE	अस्थिरता The quality of changing rapidly and unpredictably, especially for the worse.	MEMORY HOOK Volatile chemicals evaporate quickly and unpredictably, just like unstable prices.	SYNONYMS • instability • unpredictability • fluctuation	ANTONYMS • stability • steadiness • constancy
03	erratic ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनियमित / डाँवाडोल Not regular or consistent in pattern, movement, or behaviour.	MEMORY HOOK Contains 'error' — an erratic pattern makes frequent errors in predictability.	SYNONYMS • unpredictable • inconsistent • fitful	ANTONYMS • consistent • regular • steady
04	rendered VERB NEUTRAL	बना दिया / कर दिया Caused someone or something to be in a particular state or condition.	MEMORY HOOK Render sounds like 'surrender' — making someone or something into a particular state.	SYNONYMS • made • caused to be • turned	ANTONYMS • kept • maintained • preserved
05	bounteous ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	प्रचुर / भरपूर Generously given or existing in large, plentiful quantities.	MEMORY HOOK Think of a 'bounty' or reward that is overflowing and plentiful.	SYNONYMS • plentiful • abundant • copious	ANTONYMS • meagre • scarce • sparse
06	subsequently ADVERB NEUTRAL	बाद में / तत्पश्चात At a later time or after a particular event has taken place.	MEMORY HOOK Sequential means in order; 'subsequently' refers to the step that follows next.	SYNONYMS • afterwards • later • thereafter	ANTONYMS • previously • prior • beforehand
07	manipulation NOUN NEGATIVE	हेरफेर / जोड़-तोड़ Unfair or fraudulent management and alteration of market conditions to one's advantage.	MEMORY HOOK 'Manipulate' comes from Latin 'manus' (hand) — artificially handling or tampering with outcomes.	SYNONYMS • rigging • tampering • exploitation	ANTONYMS • fairness • honesty • transparency
08	dominant ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	प्रमुख / मुख्य Most important, influential, or prominent compared to others.	MEMORY HOOK A dominant force dominates everything else because it is the most prominent.	SYNONYMS • primary • principal • predominant	ANTONYMS • minor • secondary • subordinate
09	proactive ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	सक्रिय / अग्रसक्रिय Controlling a situation by creating change rather than merely reacting after it happens.	MEMORY HOOK 'Pro' means forward — acting beforehand rather than simply reacting after damage occurs.	SYNONYMS • enterprising • preventative • forward-looking	ANTONYMS • reactive • passive • sluggish
10	buffers NOUN NEUTRAL	सुरक्षित भंडार / बफर स्टॉक Extra supplies of commodities kept in reserve to lessen the impact of future shortages.	MEMORY HOOK A buffer cushion absorbs a shock; buffer stock protects against sudden supply shortages.	SYNONYMS • reserves • cushions • stockpiles	ANTONYMS • deficits • shortages • depletions
11	highlighted VERB NEUTRAL	उजागर किया / प्रमुखता दी Drew particular attention to an issue or made something prominent.	MEMORY HOOK Using a yellow highlighter pen to make text stand out clearly.	SYNONYMS • emphasised • accentuated • underlined	ANTONYMS • obscured • downplayed • masked
12	commendably ADVERB POSITIVE	सराहनीय रूप से In a manner that deserves praise, approval, or admiration.	MEMORY HOOK Connect with 'commend' or 'recommend' — worthy of strong praise and approval.	SYNONYMS • laudably • praiseworthy • admirably	ANTONYMS • reprehensibly • blameworthy • poorly
13	pitfalls NOUN NEGATIVE	छिपे हुए खतरे / कमियाँ Hidden or unsuspected dangers, difficulties, or traps in a plan.	MEMORY HOOK A hidden pit into which you fall unexpectedly represents a hidden hazard.	SYNONYMS • hazards • drawbacks • perils	ANTONYMS • advantages • safeguards • benefits
14	exhausted VERB NEGATIVE	समाप्त / खत्म हो जाना Used up completely until nothing remains in reserve.	MEMORY HOOK Like a car exhaust emitting until all fuel is completely drained out.	SYNONYMS • depleted • drained • spent	ANTONYMS • replenished • restocked • renewed

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

2 TERMS

01	procurement NOUN NEUTRAL	खरीद / अधिप्राप्ति The official act of obtaining or buying goods and services, especially for public use.	MEMORY HOOK To 'cure' a need for goods, an organisation goes through a pro-cure-ment process.	SYNONYMS • acquisition • purchasing • sourcing	ANTONYMS • disposal • sale • distribution
02	hoarding NOUN NEGATIVE	जमाखोरी The practice of collecting and storing large quantities of goods to create artificial scarcity.	MEMORY HOOK A 'hoard' is an excessive secret pile kept hidden to drive prices up.	SYNONYMS • stockpiling • accumulating • cornering	ANTONYMS • distributing • dispersing • releasing

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

2 TERMS

01	susceptible to ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	के प्रति संवेदनशील / अतिसंवेदनशील Likely to be influenced, harmed, or damaged by a particular factor.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'suspect able' — an entity easily suspected of catching harm.	SYNONYMS • vulnerable to • prone to • predisposed to	ANTONYMS • immune to • resistant to • invulnerable to
02	persist with VERB NEUTRAL	जारी रखना / लगे रहना To continue doing something or using a method despite difficulties or objections.	MEMORY HOOK To persist is to stay 'per-manent' with a task despite obstacles.	SYNONYMS • continue with • persevere in • carry on with	ANTONYMS • abandon • discontinue • relinquish

PHRASAL VERBS

3 TERMS

01	alluded to VERB NEUTRAL	का संकेत देना Referred to something indirectly or mentioned it in a passing manner.	MEMORY HOOK Allude = A subtle clue; referring to something without naming it explicitly.	SYNONYMS • hinted at • suggested • implied	ANTONYMS • specified • stated directly • declared
02	cool down VERB NEUTRAL	शांत या स्थिर होना To decrease in intensity, speed, or price level after a period of inflation.	MEMORY HOOK When heat drops, temperatures cool down; similarly, inflated prices moderate.	SYNONYMS • moderate • subside • abate	ANTONYMS • surge • escalate • heat up
03	guard against VERB POSITIVE	से बचाव करना / सावधानी बरतना To take precautions to stop a potential problem or danger from happening.	MEMORY HOOK A security guard stands alert to prevent dangerous risks.	SYNONYMS • ward off • shield from • fend off	ANTONYMS • succumb to • invite • overlook

IDIOMS & PHRASES

1 TERMS

01	balancing-act NOUN NEUTRAL	संतुलन बनाए रखने का प्रयास A difficult situation where one tries to satisfy two opposing demands or priorities at the same time.	MEMORY HOOK Picture a tightrope walker maintaining balance between two opposite sides.	SYNONYMS • compromise • delicate balance • tightrope walk	ANTONYMS • imbalance • disproportion • bias
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Thank you for quashing the FIRs, but there's a question

"Selective relief for student protesters highlights lingering systemic bias against other democratic demonstrations."

17 September 3, 2026 · 3 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

All the FIRs ... are hereby **quashed**¹." With that order by a three-judge bench, led by Chief justice of India Surya Kant, a welcome moment of closure was reached on Tuesday. The story began with the students' protests at Jantar Mantar against the NEET paper leak. It saw a **brutish**² **crackdown**³ by the police on the march by mostly young protesters demanding a hearing from the people's representatives in Parliament. These columns have strongly and consistently argued for the freedom to protest peacefully, which is part of the constitutionally guaranteed right to free speech and expression, and against its **criminalisation**⁴ by the government. And yet, **rewind to**⁵ Tuesday's quashing of FIRs by the Court, **acting on**⁶ the request of governments at the Centre and some states, and a question continues to hang in the courtroom: If Tuesday's quashing is an admission that a punishing state unfairly targeted citizens for exercising their democratic right to protest, isn't the manner of the quashing **problematic**⁷ — because it seems **selective**⁸? The cases being closed is the right thing to do, but are they being closed for the right reason? Does the government find it **expedient**⁹ to close them against one set of protesters while letting those against other protesters **linger on**¹⁰, making the process their punishment? The question is, basically, this: What about the protesters **left out of**¹¹ Tuesday's frame?

Because the story of the April protests by factory workers in Noida demanding higher wages has **played out**¹² very differently. There, as this paper has reported, a police **crackdown**³ saw up to 200 people **taken into custody**¹³, including two under the **stringent**¹⁴ NSA. The court **stepped in**¹⁵ to grant relief in **84 per cent of the cases** — on Wednesday, the Allahabad High Court **quashed**¹ the NSA detention of a student activist, terming the state's case "**concocted**¹⁶". But they fell one by one, for reasons ranging from lack of specific evidence to treating a crowd as the accused. There was no **blanket**¹⁷ relief — the average period a protester spent in custody was 53 days. Cases related to the 2019-2020 protests against a **discriminatory**¹⁸ citizenship law **unleashed**¹⁹ prolonged legal battles across various courts. In UP, the government continued to harass the accused, **naming and shaming**²⁰ them in public hoardings, attaching properties by **undue**²¹ process, ignoring the court's **rebuke**²² that it had become both complainant and **adjudicator**²³. Cases from the farmers' protests of 2021 are still pending. As are those slapped against individuals across the country, for the "crime" of disagreeing with the **powers that be**²⁴.

Tuesday's quashing of FIRs against students will be a valuable moment if it expands the area of freedom for all — if it means that **henceforth**²⁵, the government will be more tolerant of free speech and the Court will give the benefit of the doubt to the vulnerable individual, not the government. It will be unfortunate if it only means that the decision to file an FIR and the decision to quash a protest depends on whether the protester is seen as "us" or "them".

★ VOCABULARY 101

- 1 **quashed** (Verb)
cancelled • रद्द कर दिया गया
- 2 **brutish** (Adjective)
cruel • बर्बर
- 3 **crackdown** (Noun)
suppression • सख्त कार्रवाई
- 4 **criminalisation** (Noun)
outlawing • अपराधीकरण
- 5 **rewind to** (Verb)
look back at • पीछे मुड़कर देखना
- 6 **acting on** (Verb)
following • के अनुसार कार्य करना
- 7 **problematic** (Adjective)
questionable • संदिग्ध या समस्याग्रस्त
- 8 **selective** (Adjective)
biased • चयनात्मक
- 9 **expedient** (Adjective)
convenient • स्वार्थसाधक
- 10 **linger on** (Verb)
persist • लंबे समय तक खिंचना
- 11 **left out of** (Phrase)
excluded from • वंचित रखा गया
- 12 **played out** (Verb)
unfolded • घटित हुआ
- 13 **taken into custody** (Phrase)
arrested • हिरासत में लिया गया
- 14 **stringent** (Adjective)
strict • कठोर
- 15 **stepped in** (Verb)
intervened • हस्तक्षेप किया
- 16 **concocted** (Adjective)
fabricated • मनगढ़ंत
- 17 **blanket** (Adjective)
total • सार्वत्रिक
- 18 **discriminatory** (Adjective)
unfair • भेदभावपूर्ण
- 19 **unleashed** (Verb)
released • उन्मुक्त कर दिया
- 20 **naming and shaming** (Phrase)
publicly humiliating • सार्वजनिक रूप से बदनाम करना
- 21 **undue** (Adjective)
excessive • अनुचित
- 22 **rebuke** (Noun)
scolding • फटकार
- 23 **adjudicator** (Noun)
judge • निर्णायक
- 24 **powers that be** (Phrase)
authorities • सत्तारूढ़ लोग
- 25 **henceforth** (Adverb)
from now on • अब से

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EDITORIAL STANCE

SCEPTICAL

"questioning government motives"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author critically examines the selective quashing of student FIRs, questioning whether the state's move stems from constitutional principles or political expediency. By contrasting this relief with the persistent penalisation of labour and citizenship protesters, the editorial highlights systemic disparities in how dissent is treated. It urges the judiciary and executive to uphold civil liberties uniformly rather than favouring convenient groups.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY					14 WORDS
01	quashed VERB POSITIVE	रद्द कर दिया गया Officially annulled, rejected, or declared legally invalid by a court.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'squashed' — imagine a judge crushing or stamping out an unfair legal case.	SYNONYMS • annulled • invalidated • overturned	ANTONYMS • upheld • validated • enforced
02	brutish ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	बर्बर Savage, rough, and completely lacking human sensitivity or restraint.	MEMORY HOOK Connect with 'brute' — acting like a wild, violent beast without reason or empathy.	SYNONYMS • barbaric • ferocious • callous	ANTONYMS • gentle • humane • compassionate
03	crackdown NOUN NEGATIVE	सख्त कार्रवाई Severe, sudden, and forceful disciplinary measures taken by authorities to restrict activity.	MEMORY HOOK When authorities 'crack' the whip down on dissent to suppress it completely.	SYNONYMS • suppression • repression • clampdown	ANTONYMS • leniency • indulgence • tolerance
04	problematic ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	संदिग्ध या समस्याग्रस्त Presenting difficulties or doubts that make something open to serious question.	MEMORY HOOK Root word 'problem' — something that directly generates doubts or difficulties.	SYNONYMS • contentious • dubious • questionable	ANTONYMS • unproblematic • straightforward • settled
05	selective ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	चयनात्मक Affecting or choosing only certain individuals or groups, often unfairly or arbitrarily.	MEMORY HOOK Relates to 'select' — choosing only what suits one's own advantage unfairly.	SYNONYMS • discriminating • particular • partial	ANTONYMS • universal • indiscriminate • uniform
06	expedient ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	स्वार्थसाधक Convenient and practical for achieving an immediate end, though possibly improper or immoral.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'speedy end' — taking an easy shortcut even if it lacks ethical backing.	SYNONYMS • advantageous • pragmatic • opportunistic	ANTONYMS • principled • inadvisable • inexpedient
07	stringent ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	कठोर Extremely strict, binding, or rigorously enforced, leaving little room for compromise.	MEMORY HOOK Think of a 'strict string' pulled extremely tight with zero flexibility.	SYNONYMS • rigorous • draconian • uncompromising	ANTONYMS • lenient • flexible • lax
08	concocted ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	मनगढ़े Invented, fabricated, or made up, usually with the intention to deceive.	MEMORY HOOK Like a witch 'concocting' a fake potion in a cauldron—brewing a lie.	SYNONYMS • fabricated • invented • contrived	ANTONYMS • genuine • authentic • verified
09	blanket ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	सार्वत्रिक Applying to all conditions, instances, or people universally and without exception.	MEMORY HOOK A 'blanket' spreads over everything, covering the whole bed without leaving gaps.	SYNONYMS • comprehensive • all-inclusive • sweeping	ANTONYMS • specific • conditional • targeted
10	discriminatory ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	भेदभावपूर्ण Making an unfair, unjust, or prejudicial distinction against individuals or groups.	MEMORY HOOK Root word 'discriminate' — showing prejudice against a specific group.	SYNONYMS • prejudicial • biased • inequitable	ANTONYMS • equitable • impartial • unbiased
11	unleashed VERB NEGATIVE	उन्मुक्त कर दिया Suddenly released or set loose a powerful, destructive, or uncontrollable force.	MEMORY HOOK Un-leash: taking the leash off a wild dog, letting it run wild and cause chaos.	SYNONYMS • triggered • vented • precipitated	ANTONYMS • restrained • contained • suppressed
12	undue ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनुचित Exceeding what is appropriate, warranted, or legally justified.	MEMORY HOOK Un + due: not 'due' or appropriate according to standard legal rules.	SYNONYMS • unwarranted • excessive • disproportionate	ANTONYMS • due • justified • warranted
13	rebuke NOUN NEGATIVE	फटकार A sharp, stern expression of disapproval or severe criticism.	MEMORY HOOK Sounds like 'refuse back' — strongly rejecting someone's behaviour with harsh words.	SYNONYMS • reprimand • reproach • censure	ANTONYMS • commendation • praise • endorsement
14	henceforth ADVERB NEUTRAL	अब से From this specific point in time onward.	MEMORY HOOK Hence (from here) + forth (forward in time) = from this moment onwards.	SYNONYMS • hereafter • from now on • subsequently	ANTONYMS • previously • formerly • hitherto

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

2 TERMS

01	criminalisation NOUN NEGATIVE	अपराधीकरण The act of turning an ordinary or lawful activity into an illegal offence punishable by law.	MEMORY HOOK Turning regular citizens or lawful actions into 'criminals' by making laws against them.	SYNONYMS • proscription • outlawing • penalisation	ANTONYMS • decriminalisation • legalisation • legitimisation
02	adjudicator NOUN NEUTRAL	निर्णायक A person or body that formally reviews evidence to settle a legal or official dispute.	MEMORY HOOK Ad-JUDGE-icator: someone whose formal role is to 'judge' a legal dispute.	SYNONYMS • arbitrator • judge • umpire	ANTONYMS • complainant • litigant • accused

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

1 TERMS

01	acting on VERB NEUTRAL	के अनुसार कार्य करना Taking decisive action in accordance with specific advice, requests, or information received.	MEMORY HOOK You 'act on' instructions when you step forward based on advice or orders.	SYNONYMS • executing • implementing • discharging	ANTONYMS • disregarding • ignoring • overlooking
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PHRASAL VERBS

4 TERMS

01	rewind to VERB NEUTRAL	पीछे मुड़कर देखना To look back at or return mentally to an earlier event or point in time.	MEMORY HOOK Like 'rewinding' a video tape to revisit a previous scene in the past.	SYNONYMS • revisit • recall • reconsider	ANTONYMS • fast-forward to • advance to • project
02	linger on VERB NEGATIVE	लंबे समय तक खिंचना To continue to exist or take an unusually long time to finish or disappear.	MEMORY HOOK Think of someone who 'lingers' behind after a party, refusing to leave for too long.	SYNONYMS • persist • drag on • continue	ANTONYMS • conclude • vanish • terminate
03	played out VERB NEUTRAL	घटित हुआ Developed, unfolded, or occurred in a particular manner over time.	MEMORY HOOK Like a theatrical 'play' that performs its script sequentially from start to finish.	SYNONYMS • transpired • unfolded • materialised	ANTONYMS • halted • stalled • aborted
04	stepped in VERB POSITIVE	हस्तक्षेप किया Intervened in a difficult or contentious situation to provide assistance or resolve a conflict.	MEMORY HOOK Literally 'stepping' into the middle of a conflict to restore order.	SYNONYMS • intervened • mediated • interceded	ANTONYMS • abstained • withdrew • neglected

IDIOMS & PHRASES

4 TERMS

01	left out of PHRASE NEGATIVE	वंचित रखा गया Excluded, omitted, or ignored from a particular group, decision, or benefit.	MEMORY HOOK Left standing outside the 'frame' or boundary while others are included inside.	SYNONYMS • omitted from • excluded from • marginalised from	ANTONYMS • included in • integrated into • admitted to
02	taken into custody PHRASE NEGATIVE	हिरासत में लिया गया Formally detained or arrested by law enforcement officers.	MEMORY HOOK When authorities take 'custody' (care/control) of a person's freedom by detaining them.	SYNONYMS • detained • apprehended • imprisoned	ANTONYMS • released • liberated • discharged
03	naming and shaming PHRASE NEGATIVE	सार्वजनिक रूप से बदनाम करना Publicly identifying individuals or organisations accused of wrongdoing to cause humiliation.	MEMORY HOOK Rhyming phrase: 'name' them openly so that everyone can 'shame' them.	SYNONYMS • publicising offences • discrediting • pillorying	ANTONYMS • protecting anonymity • shielding • pardoning
04	powers that be PHRASE NEUTRAL	सत्तारूढ़ लोग The established authorities, rulers, or decision-makers holding institutional control.	MEMORY HOOK Those who possess the executive 'power' that currently 'exists' (is).	SYNONYMS • establishment • authorities • rulers	ANTONYMS • subordinates • general public • powerless

Cauvery needs a distress-sharing compact

“Riparian states must shun confrontation and forge a scientific distress-sharing formula for Cauvery waters.

September 3, 2026 · 2 min read

DAILY EDITORIAL READER

The opening of the Mettur Dam's **sluice gates**¹ by Tamil Nadu Chief Minister C Joseph Vijay on Tuesday will provide some relief to Cauvery Delta farmers. In a normal year, the dam opens on June 12, and its gates are shut on January 28, giving the region's agriculturists a 230-day irrigation window. This schedule is, however, **contingent on**² the monsoon and the release of water in the Cauvery's upstream by Karnataka. The Tamil Nadu government has **ascribed**³ this year's delay to the deficit in the southwest monsoon and Karnataka's failure to honour its water-sharing obligation under the Supreme Court's 2018 verdict. The dispute between the lower and upper **riparian**⁴ states **ignited**⁵ political tensions in the past three months, and the matter went to the Supreme Court, but the **impasse**⁶ wasn't resolved. With the rainfall deficit narrowing in August, the Tamil Nadu government has **leeway**⁷ to release water for 45 days.

The Cauvery Management Authority, set up to **oversee**⁸ the implementation of the 2018 verdict, has worked during normal monsoon years. But the Court did not **codify**⁹ a formula for water-sharing in years when the rains **play truant**¹⁰. Its emphasis on **sustainable**¹¹ water use was **lost on**¹² the two states, and the dispute **flared up**¹³ again in 2023 — the first **below-par**¹⁴ monsoon after 2018.

The Tamil Nadu government has said that it will continue legal efforts to secure its share of the Cauvery's waters. Karnataka's push for the Makedatu Dam on the river has **reignited**¹⁵ old fears. The D K Shivakumar government's argument that the dam would primarily serve Bengaluru's water needs while allowing better regulation of releases hasn't **found any takers**¹⁶ in Tamil Nadu. The fact is, the Cauvery today has to meet the **competing demands**¹⁷ of agriculture and urbanisation. Therefore, rather than **lean on**¹⁸ the judiciary, Cauvery-dependent states **would do well to**¹⁹ come together and plan for the efficient use of the river's waters. Solutions ranging from **disincentivising**²⁰ water-intensive crops to encouraging **decentralised**²¹ water management will require inputs of hydrologists, economists, agri-scientists and farmers' organisations. Representatives of the two states will need to sit together, understand each other's fears and **shed**²² **confrontationist**²³ attitudes.

★ VOCABULARY 101

- 1 **Sluice gates** (Noun phrase)
Water-control gates • जलद्वार / मोरी फाटक
- 2 **Contingent on** (Adjective + preposition)
Dependent on • पर निर्भर
- 3 **Ascribed** (Verb)
Attributed • कारण ठहराया
- 4 **Riparian** (Adjective)
Riverbank-related • तटवर्ती / नदी-तटीय
- 5 **Ignited** (Verb)
Triggered • भड़काया
- 6 **Impasse** (Noun)
Deadlock • गतिरोध
- 7 **Leeway** (Noun)
Flexibility • कार्य करने की स्वतंत्रता / ढील
- 8 **Oversee** (Verb)
Supervise • निगरानी करना
- 9 **Codify** (Verb)
Systematise • संहिताबद्ध करना / नियमों में ढालना
- 10 **Play truant** (Idiom)
Stay absent • अनुपस्थित रहना / थोखा देना
- 11 **Sustainable** (Adjective)
Maintainable • सतत / टिकाऊ
- 12 **Lost on** (Phrasal adjective)
Unappreciated by • अनदेखा कर दिया गया / समझ न आना
- 13 **Flared up** (Phrasal verb)
Erupted • अचानक भड़क उठा
- 14 **Below-par** (Adjective phrase)
Below average • औसत से कम
- 15 **Reignited** (Verb)
Revived • पुनः भड़काया
- 16 **Found any takers** (Idiom)
Gained acceptance • स्वीकार करने वाले मिलना
- 17 **Competing demands** (Noun phrase)
Conflicting needs • परस्पर विरोधी माँगें
- 18 **Lean on** (Phrasal verb)
Depend upon • सहारा लेना / निर्भर होना
- 19 **Would do well to** (Idiom)
Ought to • अच्छा होगा कि ऐसा करें
- 20 **Disincentivising** (Verb (gerund))
Discouraging • हतोत्साहित करना
- 21 **Decentralised** (Adjective)
Locally managed • विकेंद्रीकृत
- 22 **Shed** (Verb)
Discard • त्यागना / छोड़ना
- 23 **Confrontationist** (Adjective)
Aggressive • टकराववादी / संघर्षशील

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EDITORIAL STANCE

PERSUASIVE / ADVOCATIVE

"urging cooperative policy action"

EDITORIAL PERSPECTIVE

The author examines the recurring water-sharing dispute between Tamil Nadu and Karnataka during deficit monsoon seasons, pointing out that judicial decrees cannot substitute for institutional distress-sharing mechanisms. Highlighting the limitations of ad hoc legal battles, the editorial advocates for technical collaboration, crop diversification, and dialogue to balance agricultural and urban water requirements.

EDITORIAL VOCABULARY

10 WORDS

01	Ascribed VERB NEUTRAL	कारण ठहराया Regarded something as being caused by a specific factor or origin.	MEMORY HOOK A-SCRIBE means writing down a cause to explain an effect.	SYNONYMS • attributed • assigned • credited	ANTONYMS • disassociated • disconnected • severed
02	Ignited VERB NEGATIVE	भड़काया Provoked or sparked sudden and intense feelings, conflict, or controversy.	MEMORY HOOK IGNITE means lighting a match, metaphorically sparking an explosive dispute.	SYNONYMS • sparked • triggered • instigated	ANTONYMS • extinguished • quelled • dampened
03	Leeway NOUN POSITIVE	कार्य करने की स्वतंत्रता / ढील The amount of freedom to move or act that is available in a given situation.	MEMORY HOOK LEEWAY gives you 'way' or space to take action comfortably.	SYNONYMS • latitude • flexibility • discretion	ANTONYMS • constraint • restriction • rigidity
04	Oversee VERB NEUTRAL	निगरानी करना To supervise a person or an entire process to ensure correct execution.	MEMORY HOOK OVER-SEE: Seeing something from above to ensure it is done correctly.	SYNONYMS • supervise • monitor • scrutinise	ANTONYMS • neglect • ignore • overlook
05	Codify VERB NEUTRAL	संहिताबद्ध करना / नियमों में ढालना To arrange laws, rules, or guidelines into a systematic, official code.	MEMORY HOOK CODIFY = Arrange into a systematic CODE of laws.	SYNONYMS • systematise • formulate • standardise	ANTONYMS • disorganise • scramble • randomise
06	Sustainable ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	सतत / टिकाऊ Able to be maintained at a certain rate or level without exhausting natural resources.	MEMORY HOOK SUSTAIN + ABLE = Able to be maintained long-term without depletion.	SYNONYMS • viable • enduring • renewable	ANTONYMS • unsustainable • depleting • short-lived
07	Reignited VERB NEGATIVE	पुनः भड़काया Revived or renewed feelings of anger, conflict, or controversy.	MEMORY HOOK RE (again) + IGNITE (spark fire); reviving an old conflict.	SYNONYMS • rekindled • reawakened • resuscitated	ANTONYMS • extinguished • pacified • suppressed
08	Disincentivising VERB (GERUND) NEUTRAL	हतोत्साहित करना Discouraging a particular action by removing advantages or imposing deterrents.	MEMORY HOOK DIS + INCENTIVE = Removing incentives to discourage unwanted behavior.	SYNONYMS • discouraging • deterring • dissuading	ANTONYMS • incentivising • encouraging • promoting
09	Decentralised ADJECTIVE POSITIVE	विकेंद्रीकृत Controlled by several local offices or authorities rather than one single central authority.	MEMORY HOOK DE + CENTRAL = Moving power away from a single central authority to local units.	SYNONYMS • devolutionary • localised • dispersed	ANTONYMS • centralised • consolidated • concentrated
10	Shed VERB POSITIVE	त्यागना / छोड़ना To get rid of something no longer wanted, useful, or appropriate.	MEMORY HOOK Snakes shed their old skin; similarly, shedding old hostile attitudes.	SYNONYMS • discard • relinquish • abandon	ANTONYMS • retain • acquire • maintain

ONE-WORD SUBSTITUTIONS

3 TERMS

01	Riparian ADJECTIVE NEUTRAL	तटवर्ती / नदी-तटीय Relating to or situated on the banks of a river or natural body of water.	MEMORY HOOK RIPARIAN relates to RIVER; states located along a river's course.	SYNONYMS • riverside • riverbank • fluvial	ANTONYMS • inland • landlocked • arid
02	Impasse NOUN NEGATIVE	गतिरोध A situation in which no progress is possible, especially because of disagreement.	MEMORY HOOK IM-PASSE = Impossible to pass further due to complete disagreement.	SYNONYMS • deadlock • stalemate • standstill	ANTONYMS • breakthrough • resolution • headway
03	Confrontationist ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	टकराववादी / संघर्षशील Tending to cause or engage in aggressive and hostile arguments or conflict.	MEMORY HOOK CONFRONT = Head-on clash; one who prefers hostile confrontation over talks.	SYNONYMS • belligerent • antagonistic • combative	ANTONYMS • conciliatory • peaceable • accommodating

FIXED PREPOSITIONS

1 TERMS

01	Contingent on ADJECTIVE + PREPOSITION NEUTRAL	पर निर्भर Dependent on or conditioned by future uncertain circumstances.	MEMORY HOOK CONTINGENT sounds like 'continual agent' whose action depends on another condition.	SYNONYMS • conditional upon • dependent on • subject to	ANTONYMS • independent of • unconditional • autonomous
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PHRASAL VERBS

2 TERMS

01	Flared up PHRASAL VERB NEGATIVE	अचानक भड़क उठा Began suddenly or increased in violence or intensity.	MEMORY HOOK A flare suddenly bursts into bright fire; a dormant issue suddenly re-erupts.	SYNONYMS • erupted • reignited • resurged	ANTONYMS • subsided • abated • died down
02	Lean on PHRASAL VERB NEUTRAL	सहारा लेना / निर्भर होना To depend on someone or an institution heavily for help, support, or decisions.	MEMORY HOOK Physically leaning on a wall to stay upright, meaning depending on support.	SYNONYMS • rely upon • count on • depend upon	ANTONYMS • act independently • shun • disregard

IDIOMS & PHRASES

7 TERMS

01	Sluice gates NOUN PHRASE NEUTRAL	जलद्वार / मोरी फाटक Sliding gates used for controlling the flow of water in a dam, reservoir, or canal.	MEMORY HOOK SLUICE sounds like 'SLIDE'; gates that slide up and down to regulate water flow.	SYNONYMS • floodgates • headgates • watergates	ANTONYMS • barriers • blockades • obstructions
02	Play truant IDIOM NEGATIVE	अनुपस्थित रहना / धोखा देना To stay away from where one is expected to be; used here to denote failure of rainfall.	MEMORY HOOK A truant child skips school without permission; here, rains fail to arrive.	SYNONYMS • be missing • default • fail to appear	ANTONYMS • show up • be present • arrive
03	Lost on PHRASAL ADJECTIVE NEGATIVE	अनदेखा कर दिया गया / समझ न आना Failing to influence, impress, or be understood by someone.	MEMORY HOOK The message was LOST and never reached the recipient's understanding.	SYNONYMS • ignored by • unheeded by • unnoticed by	ANTONYMS • appreciated by • understood by • grasped by
04	Below-par ADJECTIVE PHRASE NEGATIVE	औसत से कम Below the usual, expected, or standard level or quality.	MEMORY HOOK In golf, 'par' is standard; 'below-par' performance or rainfall is worse than standard.	SYNONYMS • substandard • deficient • mediocre	ANTONYMS • above-par • exceptional • superior
05	Found any takers IDIOM NEGATIVE	स्वीकार करने वाले मिलना Found people willing to accept, purchase, or agree to an offer or argument.	MEMORY HOOK Nobody is willing to 'take' or buy into the proposal.	SYNONYMS • gained acceptance • found buyers • won support	ANTONYMS • faced rejection • met refusal • been dismissed
06	Competing demands NOUN PHRASE NEUTRAL	परस्पर विरोधी माँगें Multiple claims or requirements that cannot all be satisfied simultaneously.	MEMORY HOOK Two separate entities competing for the very same limited resource.	SYNONYMS • conflicting claims • rival interests • opposing needs	ANTONYMS • harmonious needs • aligned interests • mutual goals
07	Would do well to IDIOM POSITIVE	अच्छा होगा कि ऐसा करें Used to give advice or suggest that a course of action is sensible and beneficial.	MEMORY HOOK A polite phrase used by advisers meaning 'it is strongly recommended'.	SYNONYMS • ought to • should consider • are advised to	ANTONYMS • would regret • should avoid • are ill-advised to

TODAY'S EDITORIALS

ONE STEP
AHEAD
EVERYDAY



17 SEPTEMBER 3, 2026

THANK YOU!



“

FOR READING. FOR LEARNING.
FOR GROWING EVERY DAY.

We're really thrilled to keep working on this. We hope you'll continue supporting this effort until the very end. Most importantly, we hope each one of you achieves success and gets selected in your recruitment exam.



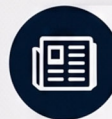
If you put in the necessary effort and stay consistent, your ambition of building a career in the public or private sector can certainly become a reality.

Just keep in mind one thing,

**"A reader lives a thousand lives before he dies...
The man who never reads lives only one."**

”

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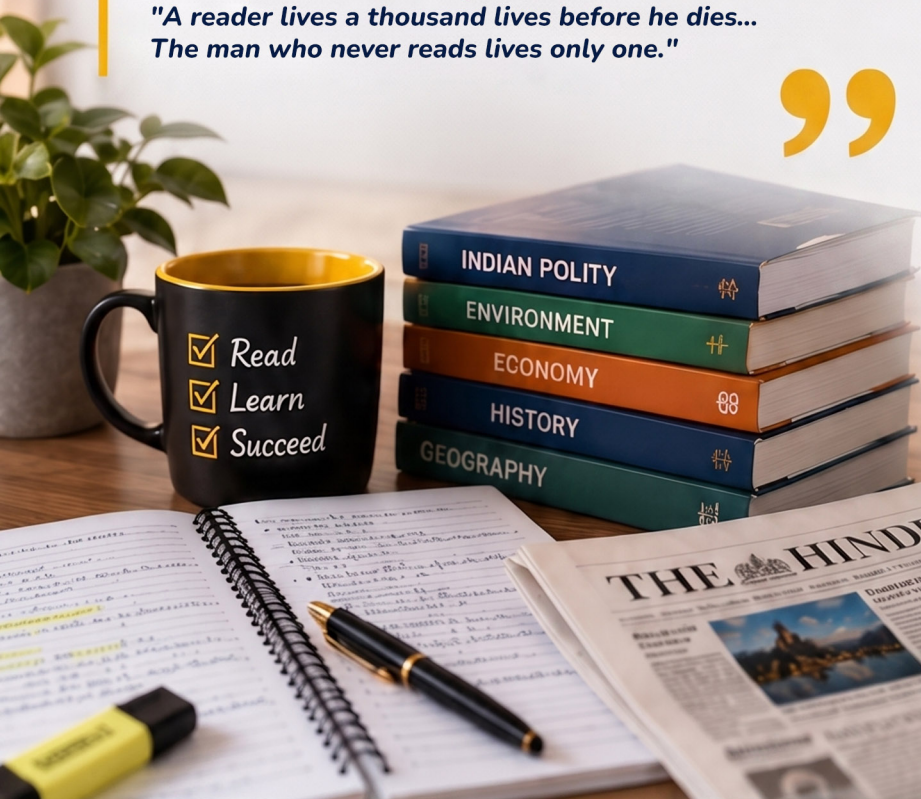
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**VOCABULARY
LIST**
Multiple Synonyms,
Tone & Part of
Speech



**SMARTER
PREPARATION**
Better
Understanding



**STRONGER
RESULTS**
Achieve Your Goal

KEEP READING. KEEP GROWING. KEEP ACHIEVING.